Japanese-style bowl and saucer

Inspired by Japanese design, **Philip Greenwood** turns a thin saucer and bowl

PHOTOGRAPHS BY WENDY GREENWOOD

PHILIP GREENWOOD

Philip has been turning wood since 1980 and started turning professionally in 1986. He was accepted onto the Register of Professional Turners (RPT) in 2006. He is also a member of the AWGB. He can be seen working in his workshop in North Yorkshire and has demonstrated at the woodworking show at Harrogate since 2008. He runs courses at his workshop.

philip@woodturningintoart.co.uk
www.woodturningintoart.co.uk

This project will show you how to turn a thin saucer and also a bowl-like cup. The two items are turned completely differently to each other. Both require techniques that will test your tool skills. The saucer requires turning a square piece thinly, so corners and flexibility are two things you will have to deal with at the same time. The bowl shape means you have straight sides and on the inside a tight corner to go round, again while turning this thin.

This item is for decoration, so will not be used. If you want to turn an item that you can use the choice of timbers is important, look for timbers that are food safe, close grained and with no defects in the timber. Sycamore (*Acer pseudoplatanus*) and beech (*Fagus sylvatica*) are the two main timbers that I would select for use, other timbers may be suitable as well, just research which timbers can be used. This will depend on which part of the world you live in and the regulations in your country. If the items are for decorative use only, then any timber could be used.

The saucer and bowl could be decorated with paint, piercing, texturing or pyrography, or a combination. Turning the inside of the bowl could be accomplished many ways; I will look at a few in a panel below. In this project I will use a bowl gouge and a scraper. The finish again will depend on the item use, if it's decorative then most finishes on the market could be applied, but if this item is to be used then a food-safe finish is the only choice you have. On this one I am using finishing oil.

1. HOLLOWING METHODS

Here are a few alternatives: drill the main waste out with a drill bit held in a Jacobs chuck, in this instance I would use a sawtooth type bit, using a small bit for a start then increasing the size, as I want to reduce strain on the motor of your lathe. Using a fingernail ground spindle gouge and then finishing with a scraper is a good way, this is the method I've used for this project. A round or French curve scraper could be used for the full operation; this can be used to take heavier cuts at the start going to a lighter and more refined cut later to achieve a good surface finish to reduce sanding. A hollowing tool can be used for removing all the waste, and finished with a scraper. Choose a method you are happy to use.

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